DEPARTMENT 1 · DEVELOPMENT AND IT · PROFESSION 8

Vibe coder

Profession 8 of 10 in Development and IT.

What the profession means

A vibe coder builds working software by describing what they want in plain language to an AI coding tool, then reviewing, testing and steering the result. The skill is in the specification, the review and the judgement, not in typing code from scratch.

What professionals do every day

Writes clear product requirements as prompts, reviews generated code, runs the app, reproduces and fixes errors, connects a database and authentication, deploys and checks security before launch.

Why businesses hire them, and what problems they solve

Small businesses and founders need working prototypes and simple internal tools quickly. A vibe coder delivers them in days, and knows when to bring in a developer.

- Ideas that need a working prototype to test with customers.
- Internal tools that replace spreadsheets.
- Landing pages and simple web apps with a database.

Skills you need

- Writing a product spec: users, data, screens, rules.
- Reading generated code well enough to spot problems.
- Debugging from error messages.
- Database and authentication basics; security review.
- Deployment and when to hand over to a developer.

Tools (free and paid)

Tool	What it is for	Free option	Paid option	Official link (not checked live)
Lovable	Full-stack apps from a conversation	Free tier	Paid plans	lovable.dev
Bolt	Prompt-to-app builder	Free tier	Paid plans	bolt.new
Replit	Browser environment with an AI agent	Free tier	Paid plans	replit.com
Cursor	AI code editor	Free tier	Paid plans	cursor.com
Claude Code	Coding agent in the terminal	Included with some Claude plans	Pay per use or plan	docs.claude.com/en/docs/claude-code/overview
GitHub Copilot	AI pair programmer	Free tier for some users	Paid plans	github.com/features/copilot

Learning sequence: beginner, intermediate, advanced

Level	What you can do when you finish
Beginner	A one-screen tool built from a written spec.
Intermediate	A form that saves to a database with validation.
Advanced	A multi-user app with login and a role check, tested with two accounts.

Projects by level

- **Beginner:** Booking page for a clinic.
- **Intermediate:** Job application tracker with reminders.
- **Advanced:** Client portal with files and invoices (with a developer review before launch).

Client-ready portfolio project

A business web app (booking, tracker or simple SaaS) built from a written spec, with two-account security testing, a README and a handover note.

Worked example

Worked example. A spec for a job tracker: users, applications, statuses, reminders. The prompt asks for one screen first, then the database, then validation, then reminders. Each step is tested before the next.

Assignment with full solution

ASSIGNMENT

Spec, build and secure a simple app

Business problem: A job seeker wants a tracker where they can see their applications by status. Only they can see their own data.

Steps

1. Write a one-page spec: users, fields, statuses, rules.
2. Build the board screen first and test it on a phone.
3. Add the database with row-level security so each user sees only their rows.
4. Create two accounts and try to read the other account's rows through the app and the address bar.
5. Write a README and a list of what a developer should review before a public launch.

Expected output: A working app, a passing two-account test and a review checklist.

SOLUTION (ANSWER KEY)

The two-account test is the most important step. If account A can read account B's data through any route, the app is not ready. The spec makes the review possible: you check the app against the rules you wrote.

Common mistakes

- Accepting generated code you have not read.
- Skipping security checks because the app 'works'.
- Writing prompts without a spec, which produces inconsistent screens.
- Launching with secret keys in the front-end code.

Freelancing opportunities

- Prototypes and internal tools for founders.
- Landing pages and simple apps for small businesses.
- Freelance briefs for 'Lovable', 'Bolt', 'no-code app', 'MVP'. Always add a developer review for payments or personal data.

Learning resources

LEARNING RESOURCES (VERIFY BEFORE USE)

- Lovable documentation
- Replit documentation
- Supabase: row-level security guide

Part of **Master Freelancing: AI and Automation**. Back to the chapter list on skillnavora.in · Open the full textbook. Official links in this chapter were not checked live; confirm before relying on them.